

March 11, 2026

Search Committee
Department of Economics
University of Illinois Chicago

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Visiting Lecturer position in the Department of Economics at the University of Illinois Chicago. I am currently a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University and expect to complete my degree in May 2026. My research focuses on macroeconomics, wealth inequality, and quantitative economic methods, and I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to UIC's strong tradition of combining rigorous economic analysis with high-quality instruction for a diverse student body.

Teaching is a central component of my academic work. At Johns Hopkins University I have served as a teaching assistant for courses in data-driven and quantitative finance, where I worked closely with students to build intuition for economic models while strengthening their quantitative and analytical skills. In the classroom I emphasize clear economic reasoning, real-world examples, and interactive problem-solving so that students understand both the intuition and the practical applications of economic concepts.

I would be particularly enthusiastic about teaching core courses such as Principles of Microeconomics and Macroeconomics, as well as intermediate theory or applied quantitative courses. My own research and training rely heavily on empirical analysis and computational tools, and I enjoy helping students understand how economists use data and models to analyze real-world economic issues such as inequality, labor markets, and public policy.

UIC's Department of Economics is especially appealing to me because of its strengths in applied economics and its commitment to connecting research with real-world policy questions. I also value the department's focus on mentoring students and providing opportunities for engagement with economic research and policy discussions.

I would be excited to contribute to the department's teaching mission and to support students as they develop economic intuition and analytical skills that will serve them in both professional and academic settings.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my teaching experience and research background could contribute to the Department of Economics at the University of Illinois Chicago.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards